

MESSAGE FROM JOYCE:

The government opened school for grade 4, class 8 and form 4.

In Rossholme, we opened school with our grade four only and were so pleased that they all came back.

To adhere to Covid-19 measures, we added three additional hand washing stations. All children were required to wear masks at school. I purchased masks for all our students as well as a Thermogun, hand sanitizers and detergents.

This is the second term and it will run up to 24th December.

For the past 6 months that we were at home, we've really learnt a lot. It has been a hectic time for us, especially the people in slums:

People lost their jobs, people became desperate and there was a lot of suffering.

From my experience, I learnt that our government is still far from taking care of its citizens.

Private school teachers were not left out. They really suffered a lot for they were not getting their salaries. We so appreciate that teachers at Rossholme were among the lucky ones as we continued to get our salaries despite Covid-19 pandemic.

In our house, it was tough at the beginning since my husband was not an exception as he works in private school. We had

to adjust our budget and survive with my salary. We were not able to pay our house rent and the landlord was almost kicking us out of his house. We were really thankful that the Rossholme Trustees came to our rescue. Through this support, we were able to pay our rent arrears and we were left with something to eat.

We are also so thankful to Noroton Presbyterian Church in US who gave food

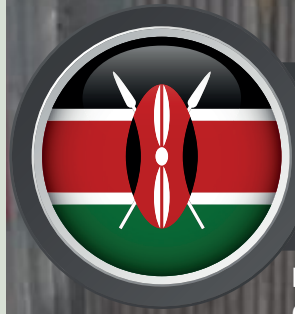
FOOD VOUCHERS FOR FAMILIES

donations to our parents. The food was a BIG help to our parents and students.

Several private schools have closed since they were not able to pay rent and their bills. Their landlords chased them away and turned schools to rental houses.

This really challenged me, and it's my biggest hope that one day Rossholme may acquire its own premises.

Joyce Aruga



**ROSSHOLME
KENYA**

Registered as a Charitable Incorporated
Organisation (CIO), Charity No 1178553



GRADE 4 RETURN TO SCHOOL - AT LAST



...AND ENJOYING THEIR NEW PLAY SPACE



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For further info please
contact Judy Webb
judy@rossholmeinkeny.org

FUNDRAISING

We are a registered charity (number 1178553) which means that Gift Aid can be claimed on donations made by UK tax payers. Donations can now be made through CAFDonate which can be accessed through our website:

www.rossholmeinkeny.org

CAFDonate will also process the GiftAid or, alternatively, if donations are made directly to the charity, a GiftAid form can be downloaded from the website and returned to: judy@rossholmeinkeny.org £625 received from HMRC this year!

We aim to publish a Newsletter about every 6 months so, if you know of anyone else who may be interested in receiving one by email, please let us know. In line with GDPR, we need permission for names to be on a mailing list but we assure you that it is not published anywhere; it is retained only by us and all emails are BCC'd so no list of emails is available.



FOOD PARCELS FOR THE FAMILIES OF ALL PUPILS

UNIFORMS

Mrs Libby Tidswell (former Rossholme School in Somerset teacher) continues to support Rossholme in Kenya very actively. She was offered a significant amount of school uniform which we have now sorted, listed, packed up and arranged to get shipped to Kenya, thanks to Wing Commander Neil Hope RAF. Although it is not navy and yellow, it mostly comprises grey and black trousers and shorts as well as blue and white polo shirts, jumpers, tops and dresses and will still prove very useful.

FUNDRAISING

Fundraising has been made more difficult in present circumstances. A small but regular income from our collecting tins in local shops and pubs has dried up: no one has change to drop in. Talks to clubs and groups have also ceased for the moment because such groups are not meeting.... But, we do remain very grateful for the generous contributions of our regular supporters. I'd also like to remind people about other cost free ways of acquiring charitable income. Are you signed up to [Amazon SMILE?](https://smile.amazon.co.uk/ch/1178553-0) This is very easy and means that every time you spend any money on Amazon, Rink receives a contribution.

It seems difficult to know what to write about in present circumstances. Like all schools in Kenya, Rossholme has been closed down since early March and the glimmer of hope of re-opening in September was dashed until just this week... one class has been able to return. We hope that all other classes will be able to be back in January.

Although there does not seem to have been a major problem with Covid-19 in Nairobi or within the Kiambiu Slum, it is difficult to get an accurate picture. I feel sure that a major outbreak would have spread like wildfire with the slum conditions but, on the other hand, I doubt there has been any testing..

On the positive side, a generous donation from Joyce's US supporters enabled her to arrange food parcels for the families of all pupils. Having experienced trying to distribute food to pupils' families, which resulted in Joyce being inundated with people from all over the slum scrabbling for food, she found a manageable solution. She negotiated with the local supermarket and paid for food vouchers which she was then able to distribute to each family in a well-ordered way. Knowing that school lunches were, for many of our pupils, their only proper meal of the day, it was a relief to know that she had been able to do something positive.

There have been huge problems for private school teachers in particular in Kenya. Such schools are normally funded completely by fee income so, no income, no salary. This has included Joyce's husband Jacob who is Deputy Head of such a school in the Mathare Slum. As a general rule, our parents cannot afford fees so the school is funded by charitable contributions. We have continued to send out money every month to ensure that our teachers all receive their salaries and that the rent for the premises is paid.



Life in Kiambiu



CAF
Charities Aid Foundation

amazonsmile

<https://smile.amazon.co.uk/ch/1178553-0>